

Thanuj Thilakarathne

Cybersecurity Undergraduate

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Cybersecurity Undergraduate | Vulnerability Assessment & Penetration Testing

Cybersecurity undergraduate specializing in offensive security, vulnerability assessment, penetration testing, reverse engineering, and secure software systems. Experienced in identifying security vulnerabilities, conducting security assessments, developing cybersecurity labs, and participating in CTF competitions. Passionate about continuous learning and applying security best practices to real-world systems.

Work Experience

- Marketing Assistant** April 2023 - November 2023
Future Path Institute, Kandy
- Marketing Assistant (Part-time)** June 2025 – March 2026
Speed Travels Pvt Ltd, Colombo
- Web Developer & Graphic Designer (Part-time)** February 2025 – January 2026
Season Graphix
- Graphic Designer Marketing Assistant (Part-time)** April 2024 – August 2025
Forexage Global Tours, Sri Lanka
- Web Developer (Part-time)** present
Alxcanest, Colombo, Sri Lanka

Education

- Bachelor's degree, Cyber Security** Undergraduate
SLIIT
- Diploma in Information Technology** 2017 - 2018
ESOFT Metro Campus
- Diploma of Education in English** 2017 - 2018
British Council

Certificates

- Certified in Cybersecurity (CC)** Candidate
ISC2
- Foundations of Cybersecurity** 2025
Google
- ISO/IEC 27001:2022 Information Security Associate** 2025
SkillFront
- Certified Cybersecurity Educator Professional (CCEP)** 2025
Red Team Leaders

Certified Phishing Prevention Specialist Hack & Fix	2025
Certified Red Team Operations Management (CRTOM) Red Team Leaders	2025
Introduction to CIP OPSWAT Academy	2025
Introduction to Linux The Linux Foundation	2025
Python Language IITS	2020
Ethical Hacking and Cyber Security (One-day Workshop) ESOFT Metro Campus	2018

Competitions & Achievements

- **CSSL GenZ Chapter of UCSC Hackathon (2026):**
Placed in the Top 10 finalists out of 93 participating teams.
- **CS2 CTF at SLIIT (2026):**
Secured a Top 12 finish in the finals of the CS2 CTF competition.
- **CODEFEST CTF at SLIIT (2025):**
Achieved 12th place in the final round (out of 23 teams)

Projects

- conducted a cybersecurity risk assessment for UVA VEC Pvt Ltd by identifying organizational security risks and recommending mitigation strategies aligned with industry best practices.
- Created and hosted a custom cybersecurity CTF room featuring web exploitation, OSINT, and privilege escalation challenges for hands-on penetration testing practice.
- Discovered a critical information disclosure vulnerability exposing AWS AppSync API keys, enabling unauthorized GraphQL access.
- Performed Android application reverse engineering and security analysis by decompiling, modifying, rebuilding, and signing an APK, including the controlled injection of a simulated Trojan service using Smali code to demonstrate APK repackaging attacks and mobile security vulnerabilities.
- Conducted reverse engineering and runtime manipulation of the legacy game Wolfenstein 3D using DOSBox-X debugger, identifying memory structures, tracing assembly-level instructions, and applying a targeted NOP patch to modify game behavior and demonstrate software security weaknesses.

Core Skills

- **Cybersecurity:** Vulnerability Assessment, Penetration Testing, Network Security, Web Application Security, Reverse Engineering, Security Auditing, CTF Challenges
- **Programming & Development:** Python, JavaScript, PHP, SQL, C, C++, Java, React.js, HTML, CSS
- **Tools & Technologies:** Burp Suite, Wireshark, Nmap, Metasploit, Linux, Git/GitHub, Apktool, JADX, DOSBox-X, Android Studio, ADB
- **Design:** Adobe Photoshop, Adobe Illustrator, Adobe Lightroom, Figma, Canva

Extracurricular Activities

- Player - SLIIT University Cricket Team
- Participated in Kandy District Division 3 Cricket Tournament for 4 years

Volunteer

- **Member**
IEEE

March 2025 – Present